

# The Muddy Footprints: answers

Year 4 · 11 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

**1. On the windowsill.** (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A fact to find in the first paragraph.

**2. The muddy prints leading from the back door to the window.** (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Putting events in the right order in the child's head.

**3. They were small and round, had four toes, and had tiny claw marks (any two).** (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Using specific details from the text as evidence is the heart of inference.

**4. determined** (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Choosing the word that shows a character's attitude builds vocabulary and careful reading.

**5. A tuft of ginger fur (accept: Biscuit).** (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A second clue to find in the text, which also helps the child follow how the mystery is solved.

**6. Biscuit knew he had done something wrong by taking the bread.** (2 marks)

Inference (2d). A single word that carries a lot of meaning, so the child has to think about why the writer chose it.

**7. A dog (a cat answer can be accepted if two sensible details are given). Evidence, for example: claw marks in the prints, thumping tail, wet nose, whiskers, "you are in big trouble".** (2 marks)

Inference (2d). The text never names the animal. The child collects clues to decide, and there is room for a reasoned answer.

**8. B** (1 mark)

Summarising (2c). Choosing the best summary tests whether the child grasped the whole story.